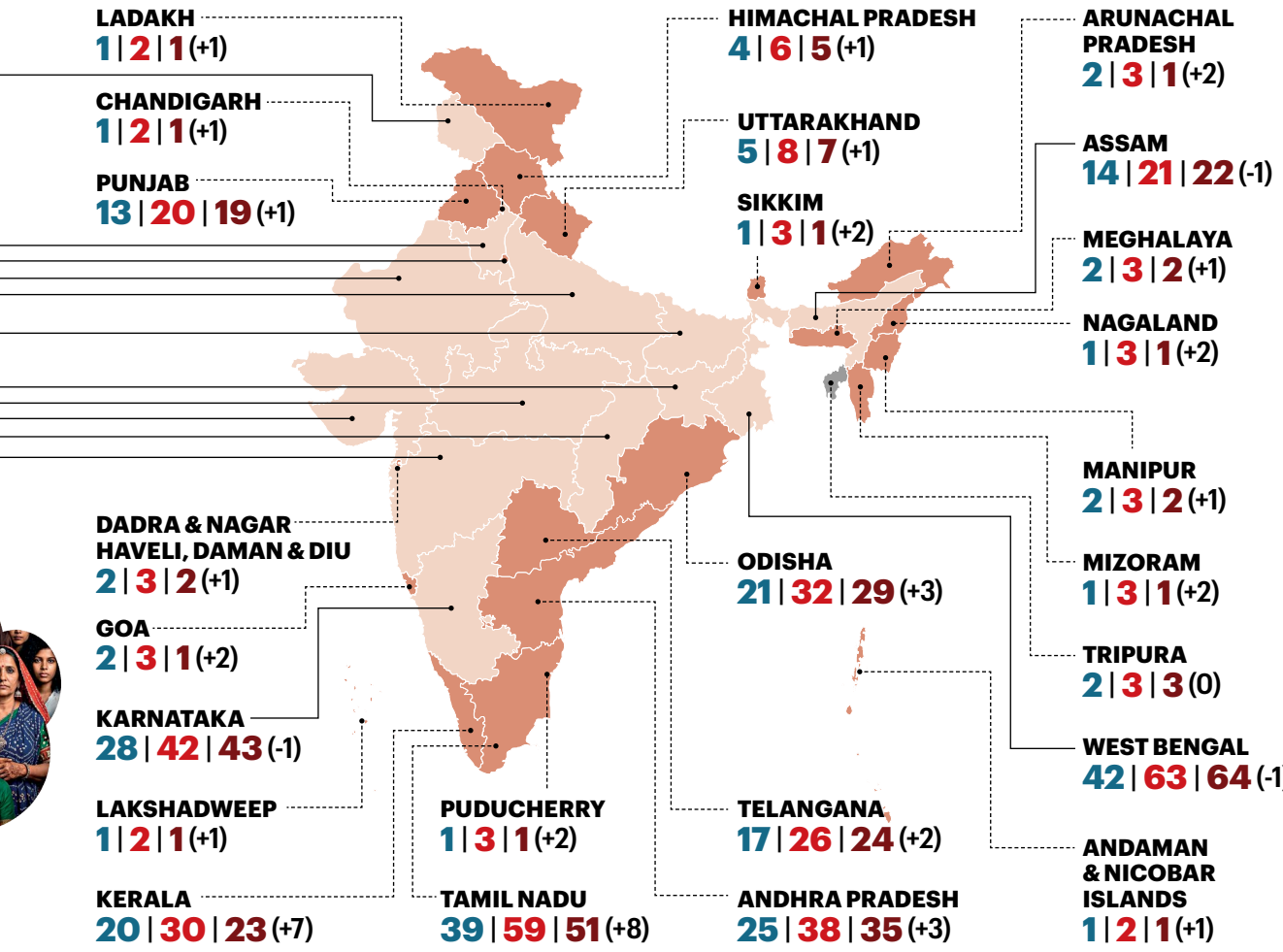
**DE** If Lok Sabha seats are increased by 50 per cent across all states, five largest north Indian states—Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Gujarat—will get 54 seats less than what they would have got based on 2011 population data, while five south Indian states will gain 19 seats




**Gain/loss of seats under a 50% hike formula, as against the 2011 Census formula**

States gaining | States losing | No change; loss/gain due to 50% increase in seats in ( )

Current Lok Sabha seats | New LS seats with 50% increase

LS seats decided according to 2011 population

***Note:*** *Calculations have been made based on conditions laid down in the three bills placed in Parliament; highest possible LS seats: 815 (states) + 35 (UTs) = 850*

*Images created in AI*

*Graphics by* TANMOY CHAKRABORTY



**"RESTRUCTURING INDIA INTO STATES OF EQUAL SIZE, NOT LINGUISTIC ONES—THAT'S THE ANSWER TO DELIMITATION. THE NORTH-SOUTH PROBLEM WAS MADE BY LINGUISTIC STATES"**

**GAUTAM R. DESIRAJU,** *Professor, Indian Institute of Science, author of* Delimitation and States Reorganisation

in the outcome of a caste census. Its members pointed to the April 2025 decision of the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs which would ensure that the 2027 Census will, for the first time since 1931, enumerate caste.

The BJP's calculation was that if the Opposition voted down the Bill, as it did, the blame could then be pinned on it for rejecting gender empowerment. Indeed, in a nationally televised address on April 18, Prime Minister Modi accused the Congress and other major Opposition parties, like the Samajwadi Party and the Trinamool Congress, of blocking women's entry into legislatures. But the Opposition has